# Lessons Learned Template · Expert version

A lessons learned template captures what went well, what didn't and why, and turns it into recommendations with owners, so future projects repeat successes and avoid the same mistakes.

## How to use this template

1. Collect lessons throughout the project, for example after each phase or sprint.
2. Record what happened and whether it went well or needs improvement.
3. Find the root cause; a 5 whys template helps.
4. Turn each lesson into a recommendation with an owner.
5. Share lessons with the PMO and check actions are completed.

## Tips

- Focus on processes, not blame.
- Record successes as well as problems.
- Make recommendations specific and actionable.
- Review past lessons when starting a new project.

## Dashboard (sample data)

| Field | Value | Count |
|---|---|---|
| Owner | Ops lead | 1 |
| Owner | PM | 1 |
| Owner | PMO | 1 |
| Action status | Not started | 1 |
| Action status | In progress | 1 |
| Action status | Done | 1 |

## Lessons learned · Capture lessons during the project, not only at the end

| # | Phase / area | What happened | Went well or needs improvement? | Root cause | Impact | Recommendation | Owner | Action status |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Planning | Requirements signed off two weeks early | Went well | Product owner available daily | Medium | Secure product owner time in the charter | PMO | Done |
| 2 | Build | Test environment unavailable for 5 days | Needs improvement | No environment booking process | High | Book environments at planning; add health checks | Ops lead | In progress |
| 3 | Communication | Stakeholders unclear on go-live date | Needs improvement | Date changed without update | Medium | Publish dates in a single dashboard | PM | Not started |
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